OFFICIAL SETUP GUIDE • v1.0.0

Velmora Instagram Companion Extension

Step-by-step installation, connection verification, Companion window usage, and troubleshooting.

Designed for Google Chrome • No technical experience required (Time needed: ~2 minutes).

What is inside your downloaded ZIP file?

1. extension/ — The Chrome Extension folder you will select in Chrome (contains manifest.json & src/).
2. SETUP-GUIDE.pdf — This illustrated setup guide. 3. README.txt — Quick text checklist & troubleshooting.

STEP 1 Download the ZIP File from Velmora

1. Sign in to Velmora and open Marketing -> Influencer R&D.
2. At the top-right of the page, click the "Download Extension + Setup Guide" button.
3. Your browser will download one file named: Velmora-Instagram-Companion-v1.0.0.zip



STEP 2 Extract (Unzip) the Downloaded ZIP File

1. Open your computer's Downloads folder and find Velmora-Instagram-Companion-v1.0.0.zip.
2. Right-click the ZIP file and click "Extract All..." (Windows) or double-click it (Mac).
3. IMPORTANT: Always unzip first! Do not delete the extracted folder after installing.

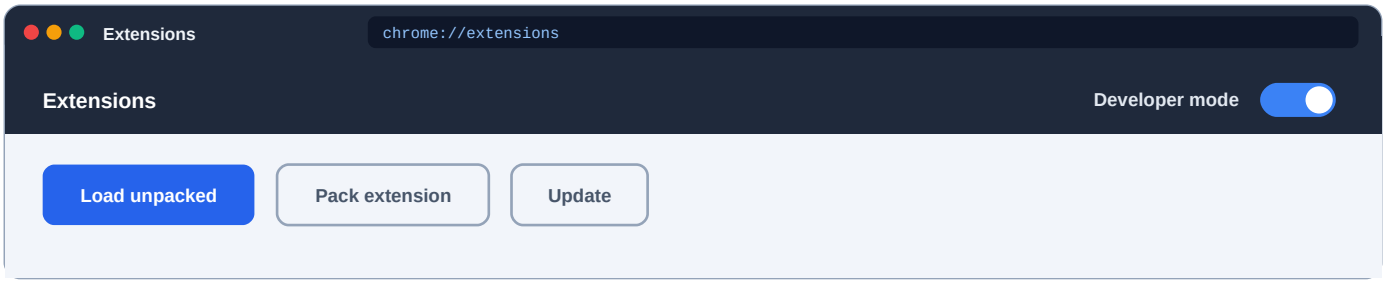
```
Extracted Folder Structure:
  Velmora-Instagram-Companion/
    |-- extension/          <-- YOU WILL SELECT THIS INNER FOLDER IN STEP 6
    |     |-- manifest.json & src/ (background.js, content-app.js)
    |-- SETUP-GUIDE.pdf     |-- README.txt
```

STEP 3 Open chrome://extensions in Google Chrome

1. Open Google Chrome on your computer.
2. Click the address bar at the very top, type chrome://extensions and press Enter.

STEP 4 Turn ON "Developer mode" (Top-Right Corner)

1. Look at the top-right corner of the Extensions page.
2. Click the "Developer mode" switch so it turns BLUE (ON). Three new buttons will appear on the left.



STEP 5 Click the "Load unpacked" Button

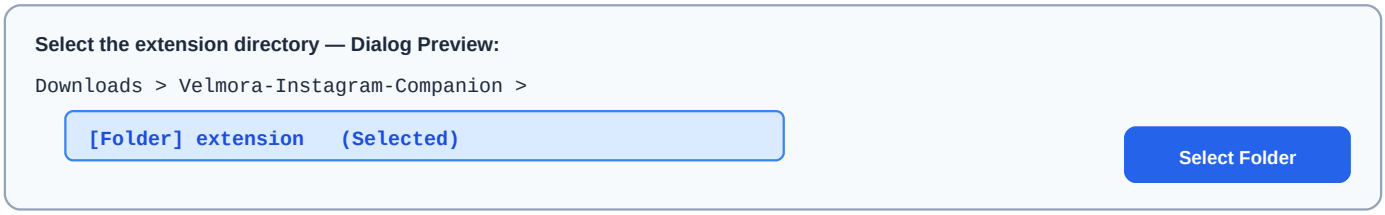
1. After enabling Developer mode, click the "Load unpacked" button in the top-left corner.
2. A file selection window will open on your screen.

STEP 6 Select the Extracted "extension" Folder

1. In the folder picker window, open the extracted "Velmora-Instagram-Companion" folder.
2. Click once on the inner "extension" folder and click "Select Folder".

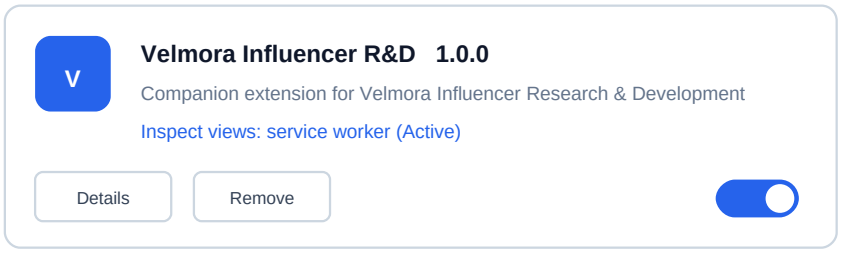
IMPORTANT: Select the inner "extension" folder — NOT the outer "Velmora-Instagram-Companion" folder!

The "extension" folder is the one that directly contains manifest.json. Selecting the outer folder causes a manifest error.



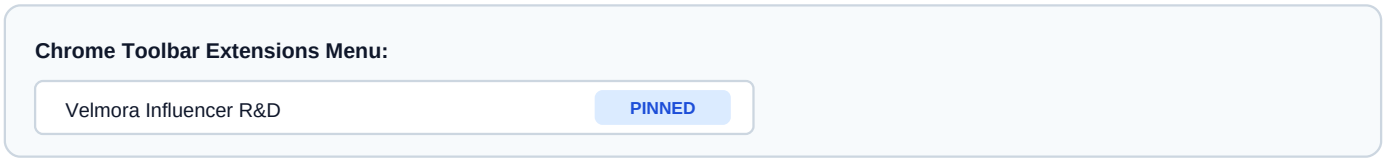
STEP 7 Confirm That the Extension is Installed & Enabled

1. Verify you now see the card titled "Velmora Influencer R&D" with version "1.0.0".
2. Make sure the toggle switch in the bottom-right of the card is switched ON (blue).



STEP 8 Pin the Extension to Your Chrome Toolbar

1. Click the Puzzle Piece icon (Extensions) at the top-right corner of Chrome next to the address bar.
2. Find "Velmora Influencer R&D" in the dropdown list and click the Pin icon so it turns blue.



STEP 9 Open Velmora Management System & Refresh

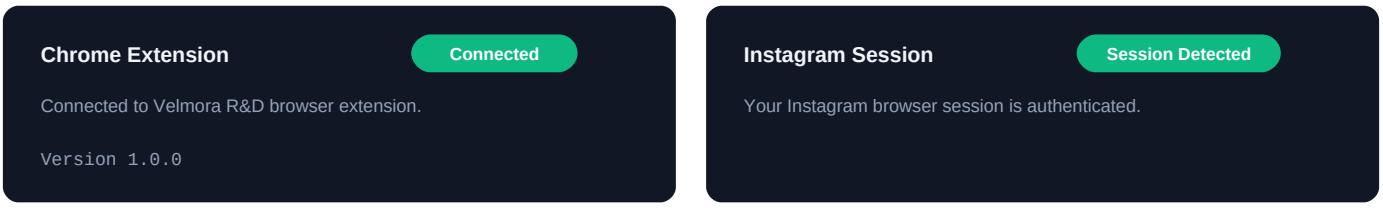
1. Return to your Velmora Management System browser tab (or open it in Google Chrome).
2. Press F5 (or click the browser Reload button) once so the page connects to the newly installed extension.

STEP 10 Navigate to Influencer R&D

1. From the left sidebar in Velmora, click Marketing, then open the Influencer R&D module.

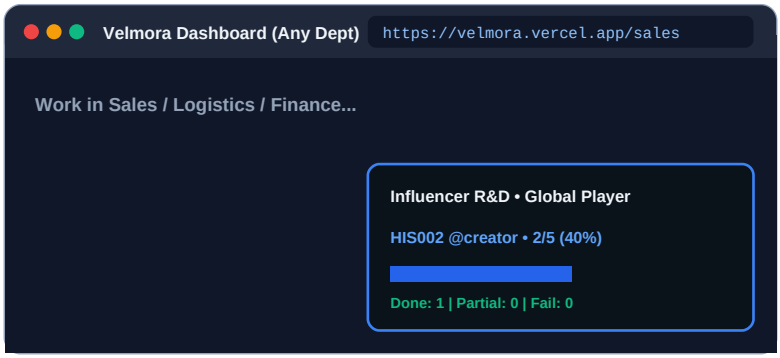
STEP 11 Check Extension & Instagram Session Connection

1. Click the "Check Connection" button in the top-right corner of Influencer R&D.
2. Confirm the "Chrome Extension" card shows a green "Connected" badge and "Version 1.0.0".
3. Confirm the "Instagram Session" card shows "Session Detected".
   (If it shows "Login Required" or "Not Available", click "Open Instagram", log in, and click "Check Connection".)



STEP 12 Using the Instagram Companion Window & Global MiniPlayer

1. Upload your Influencer Excel sheet (.xlsx) and click "Start Research".
2. The extension automatically opens a separate "Instagram Companion Window" to scroll Reels and read views.
3. Keep the Companion window OPEN and UNMINIMIZED while research runs.
4. If the Companion window gets minimized or covered by another window, Velmora safely auto-pauses and shows:
   "Paused — Instagram Companion window appears to be covered. Bring it to the front to continue."
   Simply click the Companion window to bring it to the front — scraping resumes automatically in 2–3 seconds!
5. You can freely navigate to Sales, Logistics, Finance, or any other department during a batch. The Global MiniPlayer stays visible in the bottom-right corner so you can monitor progress, pause, or stop at any time.





3 Golden Rules for Smooth Instagram R&D Scraping

- Rule 1: Keep the Instagram Companion window OPEN and UNMINIMIZED while a batch is running.
- Rule 2: If the batch auto-pauses because the Companion window was covered, just click the Companion window to bring it back to the front. Do not close it — the batch will automatically resume from where it paused.
- Rule 3: To hide the MiniPlayer UI without stopping research, click "X". Only click "Stop Session" if you want to cancel.

STEP 13

Troubleshooting Common Installation & Connection Issues

If you run into any issue during setup or daily scraping, follow the step-by-step fix below:

1. Error: "Manifest file is missing or unreadable" when clicking Load unpacked

Why it happens: You either selected the outer "Velmora-Instagram-Companion" folder instead of the inner "extension" folder, or tried to load directly from inside the unextracted .zip file.

How to fix it:
1) Right-click the .zip file and click "Extract All..." first.
2) In Chrome -> Load unpacked, open "Velmora-Instagram-Companion" and select the inner "extension" folder (which contains manifest.json).

2. Chrome Extension card in Velmora says "Not Detected" or "Connection Error"

Why it happens: The Velmora browser tab was opened before installing the extension, or the extension is switched OFF in chrome://extensions.

How to fix it:
1) Open chrome://extensions and verify "Velmora Influencer R&D" is present and its blue toggle is ON.
2) Return to the Velmora tab and press F5 (Refresh).
3) Click the "Check Connection" button in Influencer R&D.

3. Instagram Session card says "Login Required" or "Not Available"

Why it happens: Chrome is not currently logged into an active Instagram account.

How to fix it:
1) Click the "Open Instagram" button on the Instagram Session card (or open https://www.instagram.com).
2) Log in with your work Instagram account.
3) Return to Velmora and click "Check Connection" — it will switch to "Session Detected".

4. MiniPlayer says "Paused — Instagram Companion window appears to be covered"

Why it happens: Chrome pauses background page scrolling when the Companion window is minimized or completely covered by another window.

How to fix it:
1) Look at your taskbar and click the Instagram Companion Chrome window to bring it to the front.
2) Keep it visible on part of your screen. The batch will automatically confirm visibility and resume within 2–3 seconds.

5. A profile failed after 15 minutes with "companion_window_inactive_timeout"

Why it happens: The Instagram Companion window remained minimized or completely covered for more than 15 continuous minutes.

How to fix it:
1) Bring the Companion window to the front so the remaining profiles finish.
2) Once the batch finishes, click "Retry Failed / Remaining" in the MiniPlayer or dashboard to re-run only the failed profile.

6. How to update when a new Extension version is released in Velmora

Why it happens: Your installed extension version is older than the version shown next to the Download button.

How to fix it:
1) Click "Download Extension + Setup Guide" in Velmora and extract the new ZIP.
2) Open chrome://extensions, click "Remove" on the old Velmora extension, then click "Load unpacked" and select the new "extension" folder.